

Introduction to Electronic Design Automation
National Taiwan University
Spring 2025

Problem Set 2
Reference Solution

1 [Cofactor] (9%)

W.L.O.G. assume that v is a positive literal.

(a) (3%)

The statement is false. Let $f(x) = x$, $u = \neg x$, and $v = x$. We have

$$(f_u)_v = (0)_v = 0,$$

and

$$(f_v)_u = (1)_u = 1.$$

(b) (3%)

The statement is true. Let $f = f(v, W)$. We have

$$(\neg f)_v = (\neg f(v, W))_v = \neg f(1, W) = \neg f_v.$$

(c) (3%)

The statement is true. Let $f = f(v, W)$ and $g = g(v, W)$. We have

$$(f \oplus g)_v = (f(v, W) \oplus g(v, W))_v = f(1, W) \oplus g(1, W) = f_v \oplus g_v.$$

2 [Quantified Boolean Formula] (15%)

(a) (3%)

The biconditional holds. Note that

$$\begin{aligned} \neg(\forall x, \exists y. f(x, y, z)) &= \neg(\forall x. (f(x, 0, z) \vee f(x, 1, z))) \\ &= \neg((f(0, 0, z) \vee f(0, 1, z)) \wedge (f(1, 0, z) \vee f(1, 1, z))) \\ &= (\neg(f(0, 0, z) \vee f(0, 1, z))) \vee \neg(f(1, 0, z) \vee f(1, 1, z)) \\ &= ((\neg f(0, 0, z) \wedge \neg f(0, 1, z)) \vee (\neg f(1, 0, z) \wedge \neg f(1, 1, z))), \end{aligned}$$

and

$$\begin{aligned} \exists x, \forall y. \neg f(x, y, z) &= \exists x. (\neg f(x, 0, z) \wedge \neg f(x, 1, z)) \\ &= (\neg f(0, 0, z) \wedge \neg f(0, 1, z)) \vee (\neg f(1, 0, z) \wedge \neg f(1, 1, z)) \\ &= \dots \end{aligned}$$

(b) (3%)

A counterexample for the $(\Rightarrow)$ direction is $f = x$. We have

$$\forall x, \exists y. f(x, y, z) = \forall x. x = 0,$$

while

$$\exists x, \forall y. f(x, y, z) = \exists x. x = 1.$$

A counterexample for the $(\Leftarrow)$ direction is $f = y$. We have

$$\forall x, \exists y. f(x, y, z) = \forall x. (1) = 1,$$

while

$$\exists x, \forall y. f(x, y, z) = \exists x. (0) = 0.$$

(c) (3%)

The $(\Rightarrow)$ direction is correct. To see this, note that

$$\begin{aligned} \exists x, \forall y. f(x, y, z) &= \exists x. (f(x, 0, z) \wedge f(x, 1, z)) \\ &= (f(0, 0, z) \wedge f(0, 1, z)) \vee (f(1, 0, z) \wedge f(1, 1, z)) \\ &= (f(0, 0, z) \vee f(1, 0, z)) \wedge (f(0, 1, z) \vee f(1, 1, z)) \\ &\quad \wedge (f(0, 0, z) \vee f(1, 1, z)) \wedge (f(0, 1, z) \vee f(1, 0, z)), \end{aligned}$$

and

$$\begin{aligned} \forall y, \exists x. f(x, y, z) &= \forall y. (f(0, y, z) \vee f(1, y, z)) \\ &= (f(0, 0, z) \vee f(1, 0, z)) \wedge (f(0, 1, z) \vee f(1, 1, z)), \end{aligned}$$

which is clearly implied by the first one. A counterexample for the $(\Leftarrow)$ direction is $f = x \oplus y$. We have

$$\exists x, \forall y. f(x, y, z) = \exists x. (x \oplus 0) \wedge (x \oplus 1) = \exists x. (\neg x \wedge x) = \exists x. (0) = 0,$$

while

$$\forall y, \exists x. f(x, y, z) = \forall y. (0 \oplus y) \vee (1 \oplus y) = \forall y. (y \vee \neg y) = \forall y. (1) = 1.$$

(d) (3%)

The biconditional holds. Note that

$$\forall x. (f(x, y) \wedge g(x, z)) = f(0, y) \wedge g(0, z) \wedge f(1, y) \wedge g(1, z),$$

and

$$\begin{aligned} (\forall x. f(x, y)) \wedge (\forall x. g(x, z)) &= (f(0, y) \wedge f(1, y)) \wedge (g(0, z) \wedge g(1, z)) \\ &= \forall x. (f(x, y) \wedge g(x, z)). \end{aligned}$$

(e) (3%)

The ($\Leftarrow$) direction is correct. To see this, note that

$$(\forall x.f(x, y)) \vee (\forall x.g(x, z)) = f(0, y)f(1, y) \vee g(0, z)g(1, z),$$

while

$$\begin{aligned} \forall x.(f(x, y) \vee g(x, z)) &= (f(0, y) \vee g(0, z)) \wedge (f(1, y) \vee g(1, z)) \\ &= f(0, y)f(1, y) \vee f(0, y)g(1, z) \vee g(0, z)f(1, y) \vee g(0, z)g(1, z) \\ &= (\forall x.f(x, y)) \vee (\forall x.g(x, z)) \vee f(0, y)g(1, z) \vee g(0, z)f(1, y), \end{aligned}$$

which is clearly implied by the first one.

A counterexample for the ($\Rightarrow$) direction is $f = x$ and $g = \neg x$. We have $\forall x.(f(x, y) \vee g(x, z)) = \forall x.(1) = 1$, while $\forall x.f(x, y) \vee \forall x.g(x, z) = 0 \vee 0 = 0$.

3 [Boolean Function Representation] (9%)

(a) (3%)

$$\begin{aligned} f &= x_1x_2x_3 + x_1x_2x_4 + x_1x_2x_5 + x_1x_3x_4 + x_1x_3x_5 \\ &\quad + x_1x_4x_5 + x_2x_3x_4 + x_2x_3x_5 + x_2x_4x_5 + x_3x_4x_5. \end{aligned}$$

(b) (3%)

$$\begin{aligned} f &= (x_1 + x_2 + x_3)(x_1 + x_2 + x_4)(x_1 + x_2 + x_5)(x_1 + x_3 + x_4)(x_1 + x_3 + x_5) \\ &\quad (x_1 + x_4 + x_5)(x_2 + x_3 + x_4)(x_2 + x_3 + x_5)(x_2 + x_4 + x_5)(x_3 + x_4 + x_5). \end{aligned}$$

(c) (3%)

The ROBDD is shown in Fig. 1.

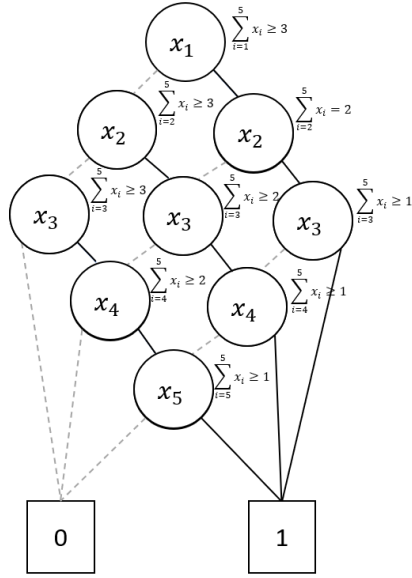


Fig. 1: ROBDD for $f(x_1, \dots, x_5)$. The variable order is x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4, x_5 .

(d) (3%)

The AIG is shown in Fig. 2.

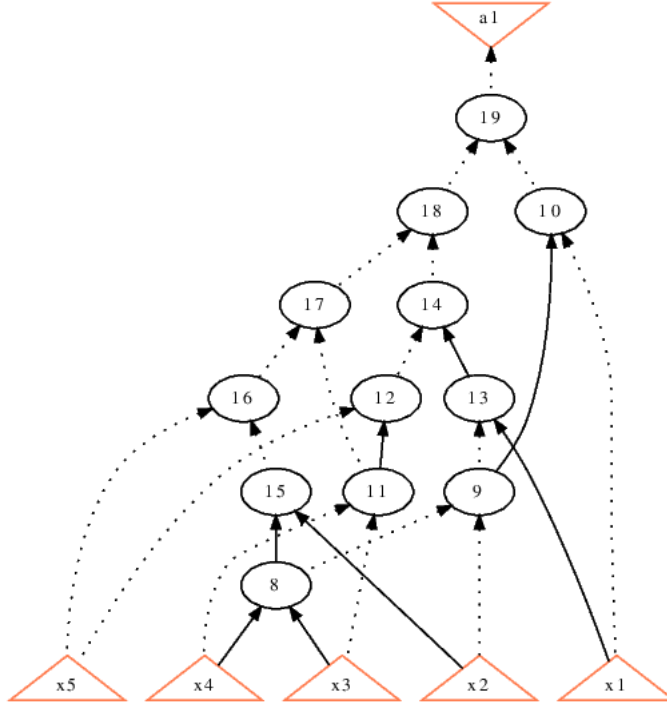


Fig. 2: AIG for $f(x_1, \dots, x_5)$. The inverted edges are denoted by dotted edges.

(e) (3%)

$$f = M(\\ \begin{aligned} &M(M(x_1, x_2, x_3), M(x_1, x_2, x_4), M(x_1, x_2, x_5)), \\ &M(M(x_1, x_3, x_4), M(x_1, x_3, x_5), M(x_1, x_4, x_5)), \\ &M(M(x_2, x_3, x_4), M(x_2, x_3, x_5), M(x_2, x_4, x_5)) \end{aligned}).$$

4 [Application of Quantified Boolean Formula] (16%)

(a) (8%)

Grading criteria:

- Quantifier: 2%
- Rule constraints: 3%
- Winning condition: 1%
- Correctly assembling everything: 2%

For $(i, j) \in S = \{(1, 1), (1, 2), (2, 1), (2, 2), (3, 1)\}$, let $x_{t,i,j}$ denote that player P_X take the stone j of the pile i at move t for $t \in \{1, 3, 5\}$, and let $y_{t,i,j}$ denote that player P_X take the stone j of the pile i at move t for $t \in \{2, 4\}$.

We write X_t to denote the set $\{x_{t,i,j} \mid (i, j) \in S\}$ and similarly $Y_t = \{y_{t,i,j} \mid (i, j) \in S\}$ to ease notation.

In addition, we write

$$\text{EXACTLYONE}(v_1, \dots, v_k) = \bigvee_{r \in \{1, \dots, k\}} (v_r \wedge \bigwedge_{s \in \{1, \dots, k\} \setminus \{r\}} v'_s)$$

to denote the Boolean function that exactly one of $v_1, \dots, v_k$ is true.

The QBF is

$$\exists X_1, \forall Y_2, \exists X_3, \forall Y_4, \exists X_5. \phi_{X,1} \wedge (\phi_{Y,2} \rightarrow (\phi_{X,3} \wedge (\phi_{Y,4} \rightarrow (\phi_{X,5} \wedge \phi_W)))) ,$$

where

$$\phi_{X,1} = \text{EXACTLYONE}(x_{1,1,1} \vee x_{1,1,2}, x_{1,2,1} \vee x_{1,2,2}, x_{1,3,1}) ,$$

$$\begin{aligned} \phi_{Y,2} = \text{EXACTLYONE}(y_{2,1,1} \vee y_{2,1,2}, y_{2,2,1} \vee y_{2,2,2}, y_{2,3,1}) \\ \wedge \bigwedge_{(i,j) \in S} x_{1,i,j} \rightarrow y'_{2,i,j} , \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \phi_{X,3} = \text{EXACTLYONE}(x_{3,1,1} \vee x_{3,1,2}, x_{3,2,1} \vee x_{3,2,2}, x_{3,3,1}) \\ \wedge \bigwedge_{(i,j) \in S} (x_{1,i,j} \vee y_{2,i,j}) \rightarrow x'_{3,i,j} , \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \phi_{Y,4} = [\text{EXACTLYONE}(y_{4,1,1} \vee y_{4,1,2}, y_{4,2,1} \vee y_{4,2,2}, y_{4,3,1}) \\ \vee (\bigwedge_{(i,j) \in S} y'_{4,i,j} \wedge \bigwedge_{(i,j) \in S} (x_{i,i,j} \vee y_{2,i,j} \vee x_{3,i,j}))] \\ \wedge \bigwedge_{(i,j) \in S} (x_{1,i,j} \vee y_{2,i,j} \vee x_{3,i,j}) \rightarrow y'_{4,i,j} , \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \phi_{X,5} = [\text{EXACTLYONE}(x_{5,1,1} \vee x_{5,1,2}, x_{5,2,1} \vee x_{5,2,2}, x_{5,3,1}) \\ \vee (\bigwedge_{(i,j) \in S} x'_{5,i,j} \wedge \bigwedge_{(i,j) \in S} (x_{i,i,j} \vee y_{2,i,j} \vee x_{3,i,j} \vee y_{4,i,j}))] \\ \wedge \bigwedge_{(i,j) \in S} (x_{1,i,j} \vee y_{2,i,j} \vee x_{3,i,j} \vee y_{4,i,j}) \rightarrow x'_{5,i,j} , \end{aligned}$$

and

$$\phi_W = (\bigvee_{(i,j) \in S} x_{3,i,j} \wedge \bigwedge_{(i,j) \in S} y'_{4,i,j}) \vee \bigvee_{(i,j) \in S} x_{5,i,j} .$$

$\phi_{X,i}$ and $\phi_{Y,i}$ encode the conditions that P_X and P_Y must satisfy according to the rules, and the first player to violate the rules loses immediately. If all moves are valid, ϕ_W , which encodes the winning condition of P_X , decides which player wins.

(b) (8%)

Grading criteria:

- True/ P_X wins: 3%
- Strategy: 5% (Since the problem statement is ambiguous, giving strategy in terms of the original game or in terms of QBF are both okay.)

The formula is true. P_X is the winning player. A winning strategy is

$$\left\{ \begin{array}{l} f_{1,1,1} = 0 \\ f_{1,1,2} = 0 \\ f_{1,2,1} = 0 \\ f_{1,2,2} = 0 \\ f_{1,3,1} = 1 \\ f_{3,1,1} = y_{2,2,1} \vee y_{2,2,2} \\ f_{3,1,2} = y_{2,2,1} \wedge y_{2,2,2} \\ f_{3,2,1} = y_{2,1,1} \vee y_{2,1,2} \\ f_{3,2,2} = y_{2,1,1} \wedge y_{2,1,2} \\ f_{3,3,1} = 0 \\ f_{5,1,1} = y_{2,1,2} \wedge y_{4,2,2} \\ f_{5,1,2} = ((y_{2,1,1} \vee y_{2,2,1}) \wedge y_{4,2,2}) \vee (y_{2,2,2} \wedge y_{4,2,1}) \\ f_{5,2,1} = y_{2,2,2} \wedge y_{4,1,2} \\ f_{5,2,2} = ((y_{2,1,1} \vee y_{2,2,1}) \wedge y_{4,1,2}) \vee (y_{2,1,2} \wedge y_{4,1,1}) \\ f_{5,3,1} = 0. \end{array} \right.$$

5 [Binary Decision Diagram] (16%)

(a) (8%)

See Theorem 1 of [1].

Grading criteria:

- Base case: 3%
- Considering reduction rules: 2%
- Proving equivalence given that no reduction rules can be applied: 3%

(b) (8%: 4% each (2% ordering, 2% explanation))

The variable order $x_1, y_1, x_2, y_2, \dots, x_n, y_n$ results in an ROBDD with $2n + 2$ nodes, since each variable only has one corresponding decision node. Part of the BDD is shown in Fig. 3.

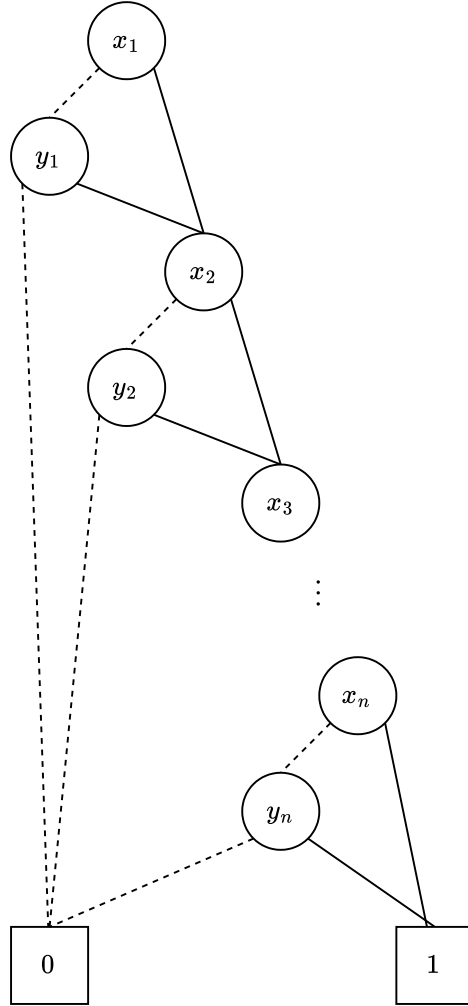


Fig. 3: A BDD with $O(n)$ nodes for problem 5(b).

On the other hand, the variable order $x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n, y_1, y_2, \dots, y_n$ results in an ROBDD with at least 2^n nodes.¹ To see this, we consider any two minterms

¹ We interpret the problem as asking for an ordering with $\Omega(2^n)$ nodes. Otherwise, the previous ordering suffices, as $O(n) \subset O(2^n)$.

$m_1 \neq m_2$ over $x_1, \dots, x_n$. WLOG assume that $x_i \in m_1$ and $x'_i \in m_2$. Then, the assignment $y_1, \dots, y_{i-1}, y_i, y_{i+1}, \dots, y_n = 1, \dots, 1, 0, 1, \dots, 1$ will satisfy f_{m_1} but not f_{m_2} , and thus $f_{m_1} \neq f_{m_2}$. Therefore, the top half of the BDD corresponds to a complete binary tree of height $n - 1$, which has $2^n - 1$ nodes. Part of the BDD is shown in Fig. 4.

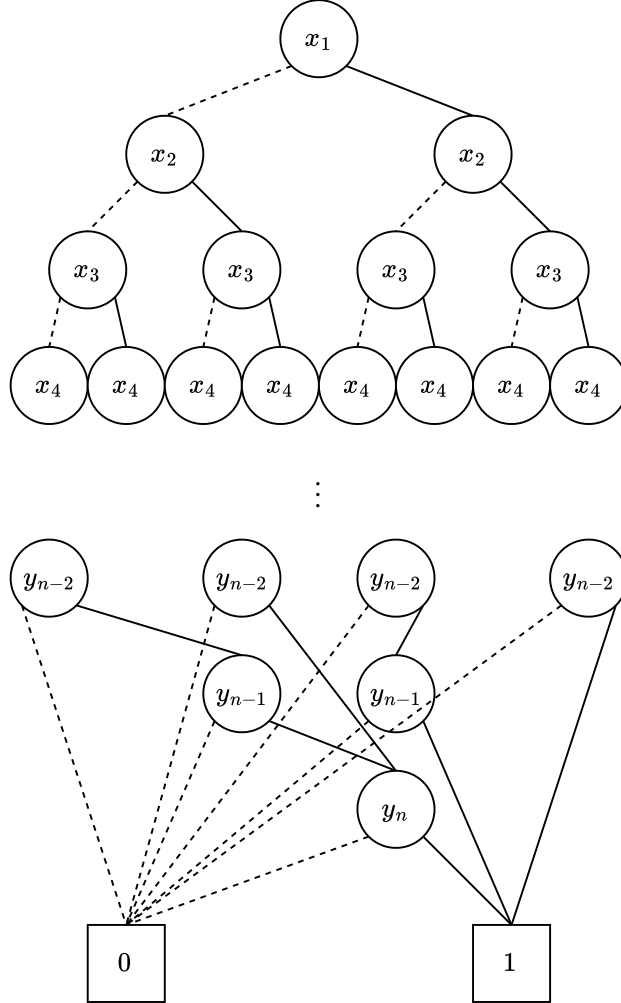


Fig. 4: A BDD with $O(2^n)$ nodes for problem 5(b).

References

- [1] Randal E. Bryant. “Graph-Based Algorithms for Boolean Function Manipulation”. In: *IEEE Trans. Comput.* 35.8 (Aug. 1986), pp. 677–691. ISSN: 0018-9340. DOI: 10.1109/TC.1986.1676819.